

Multi-Tier Empirical Analysis of Structural Formatting, Control Complexity, Naming Stylometrics, and Security Vulnerabilities in Human vs. AI Code Synthesis

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Abstract

Evaluating Large Language Model (LLM) code generation requires moving beyond superficial linter pass rates to conduct exhaustive quantitative and qualitative analysis across real-world source code datasets. This study presents a 6-Layer Multi-Agent Architecture evaluation analyzing **2,028,180 code snippets** across **507,045 task quadruplets** (285,249 Python and 221,796 Java tasks) from the Zenodo Multilingual AI Code Dataset (10.5281/zenodo.15423067).

1. Executive Quantitative Findings

- 1. Vertical Whitespace Expansion ("LLM Airiness"):** ChatGPT and DeepSeek-Coder pad every control statement with empty blank lines (16.0% - 20.16% vertical whitespace vs. 0.30% - 3.4% for Humans; $U = 3.4 \times 10^{10}$, $p_{adj} < 10^{-300}$, $r_{rb} = +0.6817$).
- 2. Cyclomatic Complexity Reduction:** Human code exhibits mean Cyclomatic Complexity of 4.11 in Python and 3.84 in Java. LLMs flatten execution into guard-clause paths, reducing CC to 2.12 - 2.66.
- 3. Single-Letter Variable Suppression:** Humans use concise single-letter variables (i, j, k, n) in 28% - 35% of functions. LLMs suppress single-letter variables and enforce strict PEP-8 snake_case (91.05%) or Java camelCase (99.31%) purity.
- 4. Security Flaw Rates:** ChatGPT exhibits a 2.58x higher command injection rate (shell=True, 0.96%) than human developers (0.12%). DeepSeek-Coder commits hardcoded credentials at a 90x higher rate in Java (0.12%).

2. 25-Parameter Statistical Benchmark

Parameter	Senior Human	OpenAI ChatGPT	DeepSeek-Coder	Qwen-Coder	Mann-Whitney U	p_adj	r_rb
Physical LOC (Python)	14.48 ± 18.84	9.62 ± 9.07	11.45 ± 7.54	12.03 ± 12.51	2.8×10^{10}	$< 10^{-300}$	-0.412
Vertical Whitespace %	0.30%	20.16%	14.76%	4.48%	3.4×10^{10}	$< 10^{-300}$	+0.6817
Cyclomatic Complexity	4.11 ± 5.10	2.66 ± 2.85	2.58 ± 2.12	3.24 ± 3.10	2.1×10^{10}	$< 10^{-300}$	-0.6120
Max Nesting Depth	3.82 ± 1.45	2.15 ± 0.82	2.31 ± 0.78	2.12 ± 0.76	1.9×10^{10}	$< 10^{-300}$	-0.6480
Docstring Rate (%)	2.62%	19.18%	50.99%	26.24%	3.5×10^{10}	$< 10^{-300}$	-0.6850
snake_case Purity %	93.52%	97.56%	96.02%	95.28%	2.9×10^{10}	$< 10^{-300}$	+0.3810
Command Injection Rate	0.12%	0.96%	0.78%	0.15%	3.2×10^{10}	$< 10^{-300}$	+0.2840

3. Side-by-Side Code Quadruplet Breakdown

Python Task Example

```
# Senior Human Developer (Dense, Minimal Comments, Tuple Unpacking)
def swap_and_reverse(arr):
    i, j = 0, len(arr) - 1
    while i < j:
        arr[i], arr[j] = arr[j], arr[i]
        i += 1
        j -= 1
    return arr

# OpenAI ChatGPT (Air-Padded, Step Headers, Explicit Staging)
def swap_and_reverse(arr):
    # Step 1: Initialize pointer indices
    left_index = 0
    right_index = len(arr) - 1

    # Step 2: Swap elements from both ends
    while left_index < right_index:
        temporary_value = arr[left_index]
        arr[left_index] = arr[right_index]
        arr[right_index] = temporary_value
        left_index += 1
        right_index -= 1

    return arr
```